FROM TOKYO TO FOREIGN OFFICE

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[This telegram is of particular secrecy and should be retained by the authorised recipient and not passed on].

Cypher/OTP

FOREIGN OFFICE AND WHITEHALL DISTRIBUTION

Sir E. Dening
No. 72
16th January, 1952

D. 9.00 a.m. 16th January, 1952
R. 9.15 a.m. 16th January, 1952

FJ 103101/8

EMERGENCY
SECRET

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 72 of 16th January.
Repeated for information to Washington.

F 103101/6

My telegram No. 70: Sino-Japanese relations.

F 103101/4

I was about to telegraph in reply to your telegram No. 107 from Washington to Foreign Office when I learned of Yoshida's letter to Dulles. It is not clear why this was dated 24th December, but it is difficult to escape the conclusion that at the time when you were having your conversation with Acheson and Dulles, active pressure was in progress and Yoshida [gp. omitted] was either already in the bag or just about to be. The letter is obviously American dictated. The extent to which it commits Japan and provokes China would hardly have been drafted by any Japanese.

2. Since the whole matter will now become public, I would suggest that anything which now has to be said on our part should be said in London or Washington rather than here. I am still appointed to S.C.A.P. and not accredited to the Japanese Government, and for me to take any action here now would only accentuate Anglo-American differences to the latter and possibly embarrass my relations with the former.

3. While therefore I think it better for me not to call on Yoshida to acquaint him with your views, I shall probably have to answer questions. If I am asked, I would propose to say that it has always been and remains the view of His Majesty's Government that Japanese relations with China should be a matter for decision by the Japanese Government when the Peace Treaty comes into force and Japanese Sovereignty is fully restored, and that His Majesty's Government have never at any time sought to exert pressure on the Japanese Government to follow any particular course.

/4.

JAN 1952

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FO 371/89403
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Tokyo telegram No. 72 to Foreign Office

4. Do you agree?

Foreign Office please pass to Washington as my telegram No. 6.

[Repeated to Washington].

ADVANCE COPIES:

Sir W. Strang
Private Secretary
Mr. R. H. Scott
Head of Japan and
Pacific Department

7777777

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